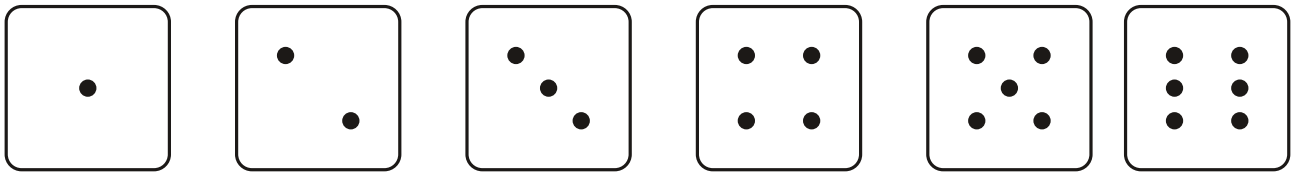
Make the three keys

This work starts after Tails has booted with networking set to Disabled, and before any plate is stamped. Five casino dice are required, and every face has to be readable. Faces 1 through 4 are kept. Faces 5 and 6 are rolled again. The work is done three times, for three keys, and the computer is shut down fully between them. An established private setting is required, and there cannot be a camera in the room.



faces 1–4 are kept · faces 5–6 are rolled again

The faces

- 1 is 00. 2 is 01. 3 is 10. 4 is 11.
- 5 and 6 are not bits. Roll those dice again.
- Read the dice left to right, the same way every shake.
- Example: 4, 6, 1, 3, 2 becomes 11, skip the 6, then 00, 10, 01.
- Write only 0 and 1. Roll exactly 256 bits — 128 pairs, about 32 shakes — then stop. More bits do not add security (everything folds down to 256), and extra bits make the two tools below disagree, which stops the work for no reason.

Turn the bits into 24 words

1. Boot Tails. Networking Disabled. Copy the checked converter and the Ian Coleman page from the data USB to the Desktop.

2. Run the converter. Paste the bits. It prints 24 words. Word 24 is the check. Do not invent it. Do not “fix” it.

3. Open the Ian Coleman page in the offline browser. Entropy type: Binary. 24 words. Paste the same bits. The 24 words must match. If they differ, stop. Do not pick the prettier list.

4. Write the 24 words on the grid. Read them back out loud once.

5. Shut Tails down. Wait until the screen is dark. Then start the next key. Seed 2 is a new set of rolls. Seed 3 is a new set of rolls. Never continue a list from the previous boot.

The last word is a check

The 24 words are not 24 free choices. The last word carries a short check so a copying mistake is caught before metal is stamped. At least two of these checks are used. If they disagree, the work stops.

- **Two tools, same bits, same 24 words.** Converter, then the offline Ian Coleman page. Do not pick the prettier list.
- **Let the wallet refuse a bad list.** Sparrow or Electrum, networking off, will open a valid list and reject a broken one. If it will not open, do not change a word to force it.

- **The math, if it needs to be seen.** Twenty-four words are 264 bits. The first 256 are the dice. The last 8 are the check. Only word 24 can change to make that true. It is not chosen.

STOP. If the two word lists differ, stop. Do not pick the nicer list. Do not “fix” word 24 — a fixed word is a destroyed key.